

Scoping Questions for the Team

Project: मोडी ते मराठी (modi-to-Marathi) — Modi script → Marathi (Devanagari)

Repository: <https://github.com/lgtkgvtv/ai4-transliteration-modi-to-marathi> **From:**

Sachin, Project Maintainer **To:** Project contributors and faculty advisors **Date:** [Date]

Re: Questions I need answered before we can scope the work and budget effort

Why I'm asking

Team — to plan this properly (and avoid wasting anyone's time or materials), I need to lock down a handful of decisions up front. A few of these will sound basic, but getting them wrong early is expensive to fix later.

Please answer the sections relevant to you. **Contributors** of source material: focus on Part A. **Faculty advisors:** focus on Part B. **Everyone:** please weigh in on Part C. There are no wrong answers — "we don't know yet" is a perfectly useful response that tells me where to dig.

Our source→target is settled: **Modi script (handwritten manuscripts) → Marathi in Devanagari**. Most remaining questions are about the material, the experts, and our goals.

Part A — For those contributing source material

The biggest factor in our design is what form our Modi material physically takes. (For Modi this is almost certainly scanned/photographed manuscripts rather than digital text — but please confirm.)

A1. What physical form are the Modi sources in? (scanned manuscripts, photographs, printed reproductions, a mix)

Response:

A2. Roughly how many items can we expect, and over what timeframe? (e.g. ~500 pages now, ~2,000 more over six months)

Response:

A3. What condition are they in? (faded ink, torn pages, bleed-through, clean modern scans, varying quality)

Response:

A4. Which eras, regions, or handwriting styles do they span? (e.g. Shivakalin / Peshwekalin / Anglakalin; styles like Chitnisi, Mahadevpanti, Bilavalkari, Ranadi — this strongly affects how much data we'll need)

Response:

A5. Are there access, copyright, or sensitivity restrictions on the material? (many archives restrict redistribution — we must respect this, especially if we publish the dataset)

Response:

A6. In what format and resolution will images be provided? (file type, approximate resolution/DPI, naming convention)

Response:

Part B — For faculty advisors

B1. What prior research have you (or close colleagues) done on Modi recognition or transliteration? (papers, datasets, tools — anything we should build on rather than redo)

Response:

B2. Which existing Modi datasets could we license, reuse, or learn from? (public or private — see the dataset plan for the ones I've already found)

Response:

B3. How was correctness verified in the work you know of? (what metrics, what human-checking process, what counts as "good enough")

Response:

B4. Beyond the known confusable characters, what are the hard cases for Modi → Marathi? (ambiguity, missing word boundaries, diacritics, rare ligatures, era-specific forms)

Response:

B5. How many qualified Modi experts can realistically transliterate for us, and how much of their time might we access? (this is usually the true bottleneck — I'd rather know the constraint now)

Response:

B6. What would make this project genuinely useful to researchers like you? (so we build for real use, not just a demo)

Response:

Part C — Shared decisions for everyone

C1. Source → target — proposed: **Modi script images → Marathi (Devanagari) text.** Confirm or refine.

Response:

C2. What is success for version 1? (e.g. "a usable first-draft transliteration an expert can quickly correct", "publishable accuracy", "a released open dataset")

Response:

C3. Who are the end users, and how will they use the output? (historians, archivists, the public, an internal tool)

Response:

C4. Where does this eventually need to run? (a single offline desktop, a shared server/service, cloud-on-demand, undecided)

Response:

C5. What are our constraints? (timeline, budget for compute or annotation, must-be-open-source, licensing)

Response:

C6. Is the dataset itself a deliverable we want to publish openly? (this changes our quality bar and our consent/licensing process)

Response:

What happens after you respond

Once I have these answers I'll come back with a concrete plan: the data we need to create or source, which existing tools we should test first, a realistic effort and timeline estimate, and clear roles. The most important near-term answers are **A1–A4** (what material we actually have) and **B5** (expert availability) — if you can prioritize those, it unblocks the most planning.

Thank you for taking the time.